
Chapter 6 — Group 6

WILLINGNESS & WILLFULNESS: WHERE ARE YOU?

[Instructions: Read this chapter prior to coming to your next group. Answer the questions before coming to group. You will share your responses to the questions in group.]

Understanding the difference between being willing and being willful is important in looking at relationships. The first chapter told the story of the woman who called about her husband. She had tried “everything” to help him. But he couldn’t or wouldn’t stop doing drugs and stealing. He was “willing to do anything to change,” he just needed to find the right program that could *help him*.

A problem in this situation is the difference between being willing and being willful. Yes, he was “willing” to go to treatment. He had been in lots of treatments. He surely wanted his life to change for the better. But he wouldn’t put out any real effort to do what he had to do to change—he wasn’t willful. He placed the responsibility for his change on others. There is a simple, old story that relates to this.

There was this guy who was lying outside enjoying the sun. A storm approached with thunder and dark clouds. “I sure don’t want to get wet,” the guy said. The storm kept getting closer. “God, please don’t let me get wet,” he pleaded. But the storm hit and he was soaked. “You let me down, God. I really didn’t want to get wet.”

God replied, “I gave you legs and enough sense to get out of the rain, you have to have the will to use them.”

1. What Is Under Your Control?

In past chapters you looked at some things in your life that were under your control. List below three things under your control that are *very* important to you. (Examples: health, house, job, career, school.)

1. The effort I put into my work.
2. Being proactive about my mental health.
3. Making my the prorities about things that are imprtant to me.

2. Are You Doing The Things You Need To Do?

Look at the three things you listed above. Are you doing everything you need to do to control each of them? (yes or no) Do you want (are you willing) to take charge and control of them? (yes or no) What is the first thing you have to do? When will you do this?

1. Are you doing everything you need to do to control #1? Yes

Do you want (are you willing) to take charge and control of it? Yes

What is the first thing you have to do? Show up with a good attitude.

When will you do this? (Date) 7 Sep 2026

2. Are you doing everything you need to do to control #2? Yes

Do you want (are you willing) to take charge and control of it? Yes

What is the first thing you have to do? Monitor current health status and evaluate steps to change.

When will you do this? (Date) 7 sep 2026

3. Are you doing everything you need to do to control #3? Yes _____
Do you want (are you willing) to take charge and control of it? _____
What is the first thing you have to do? Know what priorities are in life and make sure they are healthy. _____
When will you do this? (Date) 7 sep 2026 _____

3. Not Everything You Do Is Wrong

There is probably no doubt that some areas in your life are going fairly well. You have the ability of coping with difficulties and being successful. Answer the questions below.

1. Name two areas in your life that are going well.

1. I have a job, and I don't expect to have to look for one in a while.

2. _____

2. List two things that you did for others that really helped them.

1. I was there to listen to a neighbor who was having a hard time.

2. _____

3. How did helping these people make you feel?

1. It felt like I was doing what I was supposed to by helping someone with a hard time.

2. I felt good helping someone pass through some unnecessary red tape and get going fast.

4. Name two areas in your life where you need help from others.

1. I don't know how to meet people.

2. I don't know if I want to meet people.

5. How can you get that help?

1. Join a group or club.

2. Talk to a counselor.

6. List three things you do really well.

1. I am good at my job.

2. When I want to make changes in my life, I am often able to make them.

3. Baking

7. What is the one thing in life that you wish you could get paid to do? I am happy getting paid for what I do.

If you have filled out this chapter before group and successfully shared your responses with the group, you will be asked to move on to the next chapter.